Carbohydrate

Carbohydrate intake should be around 60-65 % of total calories. Whole wheat and millets are preferred than refined foods for the patients. The insoluble fibre present in whole grains, pulses, fruits and vegetables help in increasing the intestinal bulk.

Fat

Adequate fat is given for the patient. Fats are calorie dense and therefore must be included to meet the energy needs. Fat intake of 20-25% of total calories can be recommended. Fat containing foods such as bacon, meat, butter, ghee, cream etc must be included in the diet as the fatty acids present in them stimulate mucosal movements.

Fibre

A high fibre diet which includes both soluble and insoluble fibres is recommended for the patients. Fibre requirement for adult women is 25g per day, for adult men is 38g and for children, it is approximately 19 to 25 g daily. Bran and powdered fibre commercial supplements may be helpful for people who do not consume enough fibre in the diet.

Fluid

High fluid foods may help in constipation. Tea and coffee should be taken in moderation. Clear soups or cream soups are nourishing and provide good amount of electrolytes and water.



EXERCISE WHEN YOU ARE CONSTIPATED

Constipation is common in adolescents. Insufficient physical activity and sedentary lifestyle are positively associated with constipation. Awareness on increasing physical activity and reduction in sedentary lifestyle may help to relieve constipation in adolescents. Exercise stimulates the contractions of muscle in the large intestines thereby relieving the constipation.



Activity : 3

Categorize the following foods into prebiotics and probiotics

Food stuffs	Prebiotics	Probiotics
Whole grains		
Curd/Yoghurt		
Legumes		
Fermented vegetables		
Fruits & vegetables		

Foods to be included and avoided for Constipation

Foods to be included	Foods to be avoided
Whole wheat, maize and millets	Refined foods, pastas, maida, semolina, baked products, pizza and biscuits
Pulses such as rajma, whole green gram	Deep fried foods
Green leafy vegetables, peas, beans	Pureed vegetables and fruits
Guavas, pomegranate, apples, cherries, pear and peaches	
Clear soups, juices	

HOME REMEDIES

For Constipation

- Prune juice is a very good laxative
- Aloe vera is very good for chronic constipation and detoxing the system generally.
- Taking 2 to 5 tablespoon a day of psyllium seeds along with lot of water can help in bowel movements

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